Berlin's City Hall: "Two thousand years ago the proudest boast was 'civis Romanus sum' [I am a Roman citizen]. Today, in the world of freedom, the proudest boast is 'Ich bin ein Berliner!'"[26]

He reinforced this declaration with the refrain "Let them come to Berlin," a rhetorical strategy that highlighted his own presence in Berlin, a front line of the Cold War.[27] Kennedy's famous "Ich bin ein Berliner," repeated in that speech and doubled when echoed by the translator moments after, was a diplomatic identification with the entire divided city, despite being delivered from within the western zone.

From a different perspective, the same year, two months after Kennedy's trip, on August 25, 1963, African American performer and public figure Paul Robeson secretly flew to Schönefeld Airport in East Berlin. The circumstances for Robeson's trip to Berlin were starkly different from Kennedy's. Robeson, the son of a minister who had been born into slavery, became an All-American football star at Rutgers and a world-renowned singer and actor. After years of widespread acclaim and popularity, as well as advocacy for leftist causes including anti-imperialism and anticolonialism, Robeson came under the vicious scrutiny of U.S. government officials during the McCarthy era. A series of publicized comments expressing his affinity for the Soviet Union on matters of racial liberation led to his passport being revoked in 1950. Nonetheless, when he was called to testify in 1956 in front of the House Un-American Activities Committee, Robeson refused to deny his position. This brought him into disrepute with the public, a dramatic fall for a figure who had been declared the nation's most loved performer in the 1940s. Richard Iton writes of Robeson, in the context of Cold War civil rights repression, "The combination of his artistic accomplishments and his political engagements made him exactly the kind of transgressive figure that would trouble, at some fundamental level, the arrangements on which the American modern depended."[28] Robeson was never convicted of any crime, but his passport was not reinstated until the Supreme Court declared in 1958 that such passport revocations were unconstitutional without due process.

Also in 1958, Robeson published an autobiography, *Here I Stand*, to counter his accusers and clarify his public perspective. His book opens with the line "I am a Negro" and then builds a few paragraphs later with the declaration "I am an American."[29] Robeson wrote his autobiography while under prohibition from international travel, but he shared the work during